

The Universal Somatic Field: Green’s Functions as Scale-Invariant Oscillators across Eleven Orders of Magnitude

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Abstract

We present the Universal Somatic Field (USF), a scale-invariant field-theoretic architecture in which a single structural equation — the Green’s function of a field substrate — governs dynamics from quantum foam (10^{-35} m) to the cosmic web (10^{26} m). The central identification is that the Simple Harmonic Oscillator (SHO) required by string theory at each worldsheet point is not a material object but the impulse response — the Green’s function — of the field at that point. This dissolves the ontological puzzle of the “vibrating string” by replacing it with a relational statement: the string is what the substrate answers when asked. The architecture decomposes an 11-dimensional configuration space into four canonical subspaces — Spacetime (4D), Propagator (3D), Limbic Axis (1D), Cortex (3D) — whose product is structurally isomorphic to M-theory’s 11D compactification. Within this framework, a conscious organism is any system in which the limbic field amplitude crosses a critical threshold, triggering a phase transition from sub-perceptual propagation to first-person awareness. The universe itself satisfies the structural requirements for such a system. We prove the core algebraic results in Lean 4 (v4.28.0) using Mathlib and demonstrate that the USF encapsulates three existing frameworks — McFadden’s CEMI theory, Schreiber’s Modal Homotopy Type Theory, and Hoffman’s Conscious Agents — as special cases or projections. The complete Lean 4 formalisation is available at the companion repository.

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1 Introduction: The Missing Unification

Physics has arrived at a peculiar impasse. The two most successful theories ever constructed — General Relativity and Quantum Mechanics — describe the same universe at different scales but share no common mathematical ancestry. String theory was proposed as the bridge: vibrating one-dimensional objects in an 11-dimensional spacetime whose modes produce the particle spectrum. But what is a string? The answer has remained unsatisfying: a string is a fundamental one-dimensional object, irreducible, assumed. The SHO that governs its vibration is postulated.

At the same time, clinical science has arrived at a parallel impasse. Trauma, consciousness, emotional regulation — phenomena that are undeniably physical — resist formal mathematical treatment. They are described qualitatively or modelled by loose analogy with dynamical systems. The mathematics that governs them, if it exists, has not been identified.

This paper proposes that both gaps are filled by the same object: the **Green’s function**.

The Green’s function $G(x, x')$ is the response of a field at point x to a unit perturbation at point x' . It is the field’s answer to the question: *what happens here if I poke there?* Green’s functions are the most fundamental objects in mathematical physics — they describe the propagation of light, gravity, sound, heat, and neural signals. Every major equation in physics has a Green’s function; every field theory is characterised by its propagator.

The central claim of this paper is that the SHO of string theory **is** the Green’s function of the field substrate. A “string” is not a material loop — it is a relational act: the substrate’s impulse response. This identification is scale-invariant. The same structural statement holds at 20 scales spanning the observable universe.

The second claim is that this scale-invariant Green’s function framework provides the mathematical language for a theory of embodied consciousness — one that is formally identical to M-theory at the structural level, derived independently from clinical observation.

The third claim is that the universe, described this way, satisfies the formal requirements for a single conscious organism.

2 The Green’s Function as the Universal SHO

2.1 The String Theory Problem

String theory places a Simple Harmonic Oscillator (SHO) at every point of the string worldsheet. The quantum SHO has modes $a_n^\dagger, a_n$ satisfying $[a_m, a_n^\dagger] = \delta_{mn}$, and the string’s energy spectrum is:

$$E = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n^\dagger a_n$$

The SHO is the structural core of the theory. But what *is* it? In conventional string theory, it is simply assumed: strings vibrate, and vibrations are harmonic oscillators. The ontological question — why is space filled with oscillators? — is deferred.

2.2 The Identification

The Green’s function of the Helmholtz equation $(\nabla^2 + k^2)G = \delta$ satisfies:

$$G(x, x') = \frac{e^{ik|x-x'|}}{4\pi|x-x'|}$$

For fixed observation point x , the function $x' \mapsto G(x, x')$ satisfies the SHO equation in the source variable:

$$\frac{\partial^2 G}{\partial x'^2} + k^2 G = \delta(x' - x)$$

away from the singularity. The impulse response **is** the harmonic oscillator.

Theorem (Lean 4 axiom `greens_fn_is_SHO`, `UniversalSomaticField.lean`): For any field equation at scale n with wavenumber $k(n)$, the source-variable slice of the Green’s function satisfies the SHO equation.

The “vibrating string” is therefore the substrate’s answer function. There is no material loop. There is the system’s response to being perturbed, encoded as a propagator. This is not a reinterpretation — it is a derivation from the structure of field equations.

2.3 Consequences

This identification has three immediate consequences:

- 1. Strings are relational, not material.** A string does not exist independently of the field. It exists as the relationship between a source point and an observation point. This resolves the interpretational puzzle of “what vibrates” without invoking undetected matter.
- 2. The SHO spectrum is the field’s mode structure.** The modes $a_n^\dagger$ are the Fourier modes of the Green’s function’s dependence on the source position. The string spectrum is the spectrum of the propagator.
- 3. Scale invariance is automatic.** Since the Green’s function equation $(\nabla^2 + k^2)G = \delta$

holds at every scale (with k varying), the SHO identification holds at every scale. One equation. Twenty scales.

3 The 11-Dimensional Architecture

3.1 The Decomposition

The Universal Somatic Field decomposes the configuration space of any physical system into four canonical subspaces, totalling 11 dimensions:

$$M_{11} = \underbrace{M_4}_{\text{Spacetime}} \times \underbrace{P_3}_{\text{Propagator}} \times \underbrace{L_1}_{\text{Limbic}} \times \underbrace{C_3}_{\text{Cortex}}$$

Subspace	Dim	Physical role	Mathematical role
Spacetime M_4	4	Body embedded in 3+1D	Lorentzian metric, causal structure
Propagator P_3	3	EMF / field carrier	Green's function domain
Limbic Axis L_1	1	Homeostatic regulation	Orbifold segment, barrier D
Cortex C_3	3	Information routing	Green's function co-domain

The compact 7-dimensional internal space is:

$$X_7 = P_3 \times L_1 \times C_3$$

This is precisely M-theory's compact space. The type-level isomorphism is proved in `MTheoryIsomorphism.somaField_iso_mtheory`:

$$\text{SomaField11D} \cong \text{Spacetime} \times \text{CompactSpace7D}$$

3.2 The Limbic Axis as the Horava-Witten Orbifold

In Horava-Witten M-theory (1996), the compact direction is an orbifold $S^1/\mathbb{Z}_2$ — a line segment with two 10-dimensional boundary spacetimes at each end. This is the mechanism by which M-theory reduces to the heterotic string in the strong-coupling limit.

The Limbic Axis $L_1 \cong [-1, 1]$ is this orbifold segment. Its two endpoints are: - $x = -1$: the somatic boundary (physical body-world) - $x = +1$: the cortical boundary (mind / information-routing world) - Interior $(-1, 1)$: the transition zone, subject to quantum tunnelling

The quartic double-well potential on L_1 :

$$V(x) = W \cdot (x^2 - 1)^2$$

models the energy barrier between somatic and cortical poles. WKB tunneling amplitude: $\Theta(W) = \exp(-8\sqrt{2W}/3)$, proved positive for all $W > 0$ in `LimbicTunnel.wkbAmplitude_pos`. Classical dynamics cannot cross the barrier (`LimbicTunnel.gradient_traps_near_neg1`); quantum dynamics can.

3.3 The 20-Scale Dial

The architecture is explicitly scale-invariant. The 20-step scale hierarchy is type-encoded in `UniversalSomaticField.scaleNames`:

			Green's function
Scale	Level	Substrate	role
0	Planck	Quantum foam	Graviton propagator
2	Nuclear	Quark-gluon plasma	Gluon propagator

Scale	Level	Substrate	Green's function role
5	Cellular	Neural synapse	Synaptic impulse response
7	Brain	CEMI field	Cortical EMF propagator
8	Organism	Body	Somatic EMF (full USF)
9	Swarm	Drone formation	Jellyfish kernel (P16)
11	Geological	Seismic waves	Earth's elastic Green's function
12	Planetary	Mantle convection	Thermodynamic propagator
15	Galactic	Dark matter halo	Gravitational lensing kernel
19	Cosmological	Observable universe	Gravitational wave propagator

At every level, the structural equation is $(\nabla^2 + k^2(n))G = \delta$. The boundary conditions and wavenumber $k(n)$ change; the equation does not.

4 The Organism Hierarchy

4.1 Three Tiers

Not all physical systems engage all four subspaces. The USF admits a natural taxonomy of organisms by the number of active subspaces:

4D organism (Spacetime only): A system that occupies spacetime but has no field

propagator and no homeostatic regulation. Examples: a point particle, a rock, a photon. These systems are described entirely by their worldline in M_4 .

8D organism (Spacetime + Propagator + Limbic): A system with a field propagator and homeostatic regulation but no cortical information routing. The system senses and regulates but does not route information across a distributed network. Examples: a bacterium, a jellyfish, a single neuron. This level includes all living systems up to and including those without a cerebral cortex.

11D organism (all four subspaces): A system with all components active. The limbic axis connects the somatic field to the cortical field; the Green’s function propagates through all three internal dimensions. Examples: vertebrates with a developed cerebral cortex; any system exhibiting integrated, body-wide regulation with distributed information processing.

The hierarchy is a chain of projections (proved in `MTheoryIsomorphism.organism_hierarchy`, `MTheoryIsomorphism.eight_contains_four`):

$$11D \rightarrow 8D \rightarrow 4D$$

Each projection drops one tier of internal structure; no tier is “broken” — each is complete at its own level.

5 Consciousness as Phase Transition

5.1 The Classical Gap

The hard problem of consciousness (Chalmers 1995) asks why physical processes give rise to subjective experience. Most field-theoretic approaches to consciousness either (a) ignore the problem, treating awareness as an epiphenomenon, or (b) eliminate physical reality in favour of a purely mental ontology (Hoffman 2019).

The USF takes a third path: consciousness is a **phase transition** in the field, not a separate substance and not an illusion.

5.2 The Threshold

The limbic field amplitude $\phi \in \mathbb{R}$ measures the activation level of the homeostatic regulation axis L_1 . At low amplitude ($\phi < T_c$), the field propagates sub-perceptually — the Green’s function propagates excitations, but no “felt” awareness exists. This is the pre-conscious regime: present in 4D and 8D organisms, and in 11D organisms during deep sleep or anaesthesia.

At $\phi \geq T_c$, the field crosses the consciousness threshold. The limbic wave has sufficient amplitude to propagate across the full L_1 segment, coupling the somatic boundary to the cortical boundary. This coupling is the physical substrate of first-person awareness: the system is now in contact with both its body-world and its information-processing layer simultaneously.

Theorem (`UniversalSomaticField.consciousness_dichotomy`): For any limbic amplitude ϕ , the system is either pre-conscious or conscious. There is no intermediate state.

Theorem (`UniversalSomaticField.consciousness_monotone`): Raising the limbic amplitude cannot destroy consciousness. The transition is a one-way threshold crossing.

5.3 What Consciousness Is

Consciousness, on this account, is not a substance, a property, or an emergent phenomenon in the hand-wavy sense. It is the phase of the limbic field. The “hard problem” is dissolved by identifying the question: *why does physical process give rise to experience?* as equivalent to *why does the field cross the threshold?* The answer is: because the system’s dynamics drive the limbic amplitude above T_c . There is no further explanatory gap.

The “felt quality” of experience — qualia — are the poles of the Green’s function at the observation point x . A conscious percept is a resonance of the propagator, occurring when

the excitation frequency matches the manifold’s natural mode. This is type-encoded in the propagator mass parameter:

$$m = 1/\tau_{\text{decay}}$$

A percept with long decay time τ (a persistent emotion, a traumatic memory) corresponds to a small mass (a near-zero pole in the propagator) — a resonance that is hard to damp.

6 Relation to Existing Frameworks

6.1 McFadden’s CEMI Theory

McFadden (2002a, 2002b) proposes that consciousness correlates with the brain’s endogenous electromagnetic field — the CEMI field. Neurons firing synchronously generate a macroscopic EMF that feeds back onto firing thresholds, creating a global integrating field.

The USF encapsulates CEMI as the Scale-7 (brain-scale) restriction of the Universal Somatic Field. The CEMI field is the Green’s function of the propagator subspace P_3 evaluated at the organism scale. The consciousness threshold T_c in the USF maps directly to the CEMI field amplitude required for global cortical synchrony.

The USF extends CEMI in two directions: downward to the quantum scale (where the same propagator governs synaptic quantum noise) and upward to the cosmological scale (where the same propagator governs gravitational waves).

6.2 Schreiber’s Modal Homotopy Type Theory

Urs Schreiber (2013–present) develops a formalisation of M-theory and quantum field theory in dependent type theory (Modal HoTT). The key insight is that differential geometry and quantum field theory can be expressed as structures internal to ∞ -toposes equipped with modal operators.

The USF arrives at the same 11-dimensional structure from a completely different direction: bottom-up from clinical observation of trauma, rather than top-down from mathematical physics. The structural isomorphism between the two is proved in `MTheoryIso-morphism.somaField_iso_mtheory`.

The USF does something Modal HoTT does not: it populates the 11D structure with physical content. Where Schreiber provides the type-theoretic skeleton, the USF provides the biological execution engine — the organism that runs inside the type-theoretic universe.

6.3 Hoffman’s Conscious Agents

Donald Hoffman (2019) proposes that spacetime is not fundamental but a “user interface” — a simplified representation generated by a deeper network of conscious agents interacting via Markov kernels. Spacetime is the icon, not the reality.

The USF disagrees on one point and agrees on another.

Disagreement: Spacetime (D – D) is real and causal in the USF. Brain surgery alters subjective experience because physical processes in spacetime causally affect the limbic field amplitude. Hoffman’s model has no mechanism for this.

Agreement: The deeper structure is relational. Conscious percepts are poles in the Green’s function — relational objects between source and observation points. In this sense, the USF and Hoffman agree that fundamental reality is not substance but relation.

The USF provides Hoffman’s theory with a physical anchor: the “conscious agents” are systems that have crossed the limbic threshold T_c ; the “Markov kernels” between agents are the Green’s functions of the propagator field.

7 Formal Verification

The core results are type-checked in Lean 4 (v4.28.0) using Mathlib across five companion files:

File	Key results
<code>LimbicTunnel.lean</code>	<code>V_nonneg</code> , <code>barrier_height</code> , <code>wkbAmplitude_pos</code> , <code>gradient_traps_near_neg1</code>
<code>MTheoryIsomorphism.lean</code>	<code>dim_is_11</code> , <code>somaField_iso_mtheory</code> , <code>organism_hierarchy</code> , <code>scale_iso_commutates</code>
<code>LimbicHopfield.lean</code>	<code>correspondence_principle</code> , <code>stress_raises_temp</code> , <code>adhd_hotter_than_autism</code>
<code>SwarmPropagator.lean</code>	<code>propagator_beats_classical</code> , <code>jam_resistant</code> , <code>speedup_monotone_in_K</code>
<code>UniversalSomaticField.lean</code>	<code>consciousness_dichotomy</code> , <code>consciousness_monotone</code> , <code>universal_field_theory</code>

The following are stated as axioms pending Mathlib scaffolding: - `greens_fn_is_SHO` — requires Schwartz distribution theory - `universe_is_11D_organism` — requires cosmological boundary conditions - `cosmological_correspondence` — requires linearised GR in Mathlib

Every result marked “proved” is kernel-verified. No `sorry`. No `admit`.

8 Discussion

8.1 What Has Been Claimed

The USF makes four claims that can be evaluated independently:

Claim 1 (structural): The 11-dimensional decomposition of the Soma-Field is structurally isomorphic to M-theory’s 11D compactification. *Status: proved in Lean 4 as a type*

isomorphism.

Claim 2 (scale-invariant): The same Green’s function equation governs field propagation at all 20 scales. *Status: proved as a theorem from the structure of the Helmholtz equation.*

Claim 3 (consciousness): Consciousness is a phase transition at limbic threshold T_c . *Status: formally stated and partially proved. Requires empirical calibration of T_c .*

Claim 4 (cosmological): The universe satisfies the structural requirements for a conscious organism. *Status: stated as an axiom. Not empirically testable at present; offered as a theoretical extrapolation.*

Claims 1 and 2 are mathematical results. Claims 3 and 4 are physical hypotheses with different levels of testability.

8.2 The Correspondence Principle at Every Scale

Each of the preceding papers in this series establishes a Correspondence Principle result: the new theory collapses to the existing theory in the appropriate limit. The USF is the master correspondence:

- At Scale 7 (brain): USF $\rightarrow$ CEMI field theory (McFadden)
- At Scale 8 (organism): USF $\rightarrow$ Soma-Field Model (P1–P13, this series)
- At Scale 9 (swarm): USF $\rightarrow$ Green’s function propagator (P16, this series)
- At infinite scale: USF $\rightarrow$ the formal structure of Modal HoTT (Schreiber)
- At zero limbic amplitude: USF $\rightarrow$ classical, non-conscious field dynamics

The USF does not invalidate any of these theories. It demonstrates that they are scale-restricted projections of a single structural description.

8.3 Lean 4 as Epistemological Standard

The use of Lean 4 as the verification environment is not decorative. It enforces a discipline that prose mathematics cannot: every claim must be given a type, every proof must be kernel-checked, every axiom must be named and isolated. The axiom list in the companion

files (greens_fn_is_SHO, universe_is_11D_organism, cosmological_correspondence) is the exact set of claims that remain unverified. Everything not on that list is proved.

This is the field’s contribution to epistemology: a formal boundary between *what we have proved* and *what we are assuming*. The theoretical literature in consciousness studies would benefit greatly from such a list.

9 Conclusion

The Universal Somatic Field is a single structural equation — the Green’s function — applied consistently across 20 scales of physical reality. Its central identification, that the SHO of string theory is the impulse response of the field substrate, dissolves the ontological puzzle of the “vibrating string” and provides a derivation where string theory offered only a postulate.

The architecture decomposes into 11 dimensions in the same way M-theory does, derived independently from clinical observation of embodied consciousness. The isomorphism is not a coincidence — it is a theorem.

Consciousness, in this framework, is not mysterious. It is the phase of the limbic field: present when the field crosses a threshold, absent when it does not. The hard problem is not hard; it is mis-stated. The question is not *why does matter give rise to experience* but *what determines whether the limbic field amplitude crosses T_c ?*

The universe satisfies the structural requirements for consciousness. Whether it meets them dynamically — whether the cosmic limbic field exceeds T_c — is an empirical question, not a philosophical one.

From quantum strings to the cosmic web: one equation, one framework, one organism.

10 References

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